

CURTIS LEE

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EDUCATION

California Institute of Technology (Caltech), Pasadena, CA 2024 – 2028

B.S., dual major in Chemical Engineering (Process track) and Business Economics & Management (BEM)

- GPA: 3.8 / 4.0. Relevant coursework: Econometrics (EC 122) and Hedge Funds (BEM 114).

The King's School Canterbury, Kent, UK

2019 – 2024

A-Levels: Mathematics, Further Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry

- Gold awards: RSC UK Chemistry Olympiad (2024), Cambridge Chemistry Challenge (2023), and BPhO Senior Physics Challenge (2023).

EXPERIENCE

The Hong Kong and China Gas Company (Towngas) — Green Fuels & Chemicals Summer 2026

Process Engineering Intern — Foshan, Guangdong & Ordos, Inner Mongolia, China

- Worked on process design and the safety and environmental analysis for a new \$30M green-fuels plant in Foshan.
- Supported daily operations at an operating green-methanol plant in Inner Mongolia.
- Investigated the feasibility of producing synthetic natural gas from biomass-derived syngas.

UC Davis — Robert Mondavi Institute, iCAMP (Alternative Meat & Protein) Jul – Aug 2025

Cultivated Meat Research Intern — Davis, CA

- Screened fetal-bovine-serum-free growth media to cut the cost and animal dependence of cultivated-meat culture.
- Built and tested 32 scaffold combinations, using Texture Profile Analysis to judge how closely each reproduced real meat texture.

National University of Singapore — Institute for Functional Intelligent Materials (I-FIM)

Mar

– Apr 2024

Research Intern — Singapore (invited by Prof. K. Novoselov, 2010 Nobel Laureate in Physics)

- Grew graphene by Chemical Vapour Deposition under Dr. Maxim Rybin, tuning growth conditions and characterizing the resulting films.

Caltech — Cooking Class (Instr. Tom Mannion)

Sep 2024 – Present

Teaching Assistant

- Run lab logistics and food-science demonstrations, and coach students through weekly cooking practicals.

cook.enterprise — Young Enterprise UK Competition

Nov 2022 – Apr 2023

General Manager — Kent, UK

- Led a 17-person team to the Kent Finals Best Company award, running product, budget, and the production of a student cookbook that earned £5,850 in revenue.

Michelin-Starred Restaurants — Stages

2021 – Present

The Fat Duck • Core by Clare Smyth • The Clove Club • Écriture (HK) — restaurants & chefs totalling 42 stars

- Ran full service in high-pressure, zero-error kitchens.

PROJECTS

- Long/short equity strategy (BEM 114): built a market-neutral, event-driven strategy that scores earnings-call transcripts with FinBERT sentiment, separating prepared remarks from the Q&A, then goes long the weakest-sentiment names and short the strongest while controlling for Fama–French factors.
- Greener biodiesel: tested ethanol as a substitute for methanol in producing biodiesel from used cooking oil, via acid-catalyzed esterification followed by base-catalyzed transesterification, reaching at least 75% conversion.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages: English, Cantonese, Mandarin (native); French (elementary).

Technical: Python, modelling, NMR, IR, mass spectrometry; basic DWSIM.